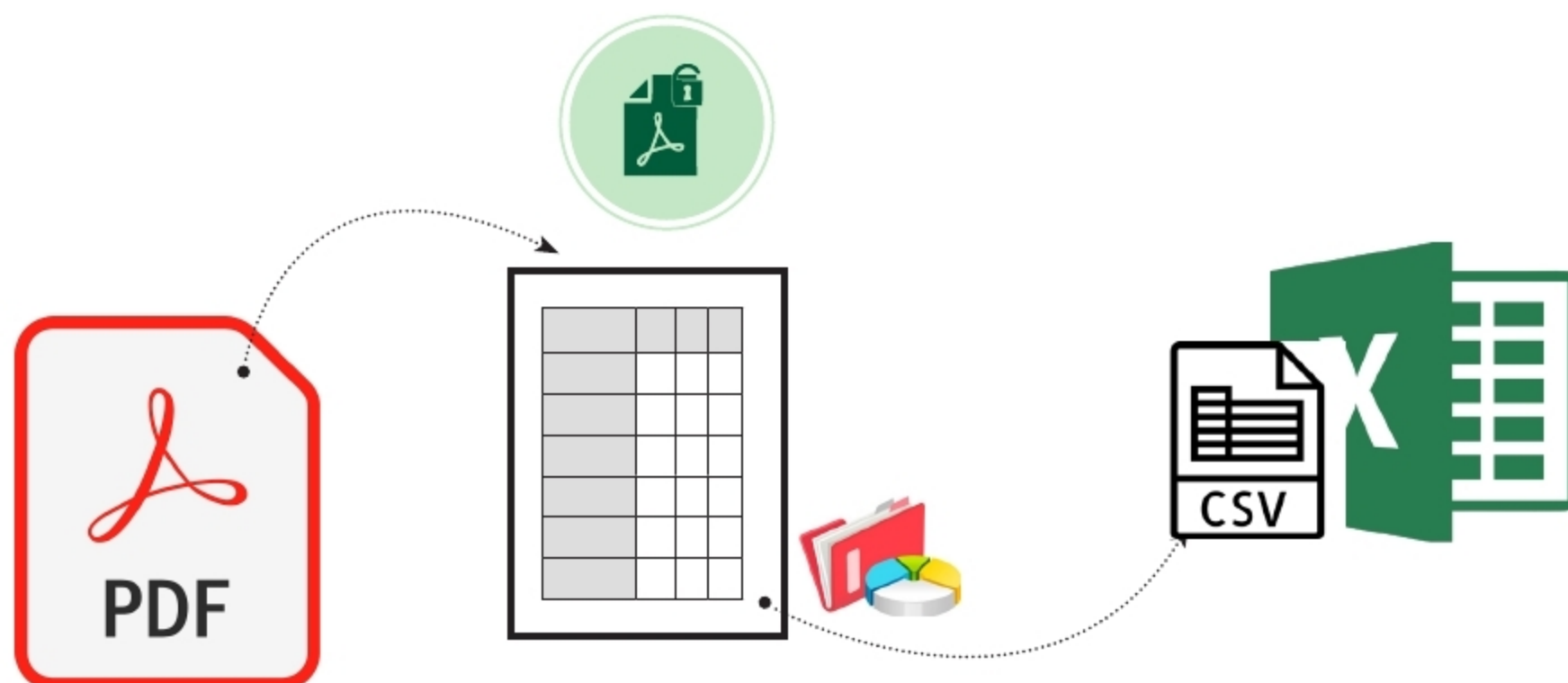


Tabula: Use this FOSS Tool to Extract Data from PDF Files

Due to the very heavy use of the Internet and social media, a huge amount of data is being generated every instance, all over the world. This data is useless unless it is collected, stored and analysed to derive useful conclusions that drive business and commerce. Tabula is a tool that extracts tabular data from PDF documents.



The Portable Document Format or PDF is used by most organisations today to create and disseminate information from online portals. Public information, notices, reports, etc, are released on online channels as PDF files so that the original formatting is retained.

Popular tools for the extraction of data from multiple sources

In data analytics, extraction, loading and transformation (ETL) are very important for the data set to be analysed effectively. Table 1 features the tools (and the related URLs) used by data scientists to fetch real-time data from Web portals and multiple sources.

Using Tabula to extract data from PDF files and reports

Tabula is a powerful tool used by data scientists and researchers to extract data from PDF files. Government reports, research papers and corporate documents are generally released and uploaded as PDF files. These may have the data in the form of tables. If these tables are directly copied and pasted to word processing applications like MS Word, the formatting gets changed and a lot of time is wasted in reformatting this data. But with Tabula, the tables in PDF files can be extracted easily without the formatting being tampered with.

Tables that are extracted and loaded from PDF files using Tabula can be transformed into multiple formats including Comma Separate Values (CSV), JavaScript Object Notation (JSON), Tab Separated Values (TSV) and Script formats. These formats can be directly accessed and manipulated using multiple programming languages for data analytics and predictive knowledge discovery.

Tabula can be downloaded from <https://github.com/tabulapdf/tabula/releases/download/v1.2.1/tabula-win-1.2.1.zip>. It can be downloaded in the form of a compressed Zip folder, which is extracted. The directory structure and the files that are available in Tabula